

Weather vane
Many later Viking ships had a highly decorative weather vane, made of gilded bronze, attached to the prow.

Built for speed
Skuldelev 2 was the product of Viking shipbuilding technology at its most advanced. Its modern reincarnation, the *Havhingsten*, has been fitted with 112 sq m (1,200 sq ft) of sail. With this and its superbly streamlined hull, it is thought that, given a favourable wind, the ship will be able to attain a speed of 20 knots.



Oars
The pine oars are about 4.55m (15ft) long with blades just 15cm (6in) across. It has been found that this width is the most effective for rowing long distances at sea.





Blowing horn
The Vikings used blowing horns to call their ships together. They could be heard from long distances and would have been especially useful at night and in foggy weather.

Mast and mast fish
The mast slotted into the keelson, a block of wood in the bottom of the boat, and the "mast fish", seen here at the centre of the ship at deck level.



Seating arrangements
The narrow benches may look uncomfortable, but they allowed the oarsmen to shift position regularly on a long journey. There was enough space between them for a man to lie down and rest.

Rowing for the shore
Vikings fixed their shields to the ship's gunwhale as a defence against spears and arrows. The warlike appearance of the ship must have intimidated any watching enemy.

